

The bigger shift is architectural and strategic. Apple has standardised the integration on Model Context Protocol (MCP), an open standard created by Anthropic. Any MCP-compatible agent, not just Claude or Codex, can connect to Xcode, even from outside the app. The move marks a rare departure from Apple's historically closed ecosystem and opens the door to third-party and open source AI tools, positioning Xcode as a vendor-neutral agent platform.

Apple has also worked with Anthropic and OpenAI to reduce token costs and improve tool-calling efficiency. Agents install in one click and auto-update.

Limits remain. There is no direct MCP debugging tool, runtime issues still require manual intervention, and multiple agents cannot run simultaneously on the same project. Security concerns persist. David Mytton, founder and CEO of Arcjet, warned AI-developed software "into production will lead to catastrophic problems... There's going to be some big explosions coming!"

LibreOffice 26.2 comes with native Markdown support

LibreOffice 26.2 has been released by The Document Foundation, strengthening its position as a fully free and open source office suite for Windows, macOS, and Linux, with support for more than 120 languages. The community-driven update focuses on open standards, performance, compatibility, and privacy, offering organisations a credible alternative to proprietary productivity software.

The headline feature is native Markdown support. Users can now directly import Markdown files via file selection or clipboard and export documents back to the format, improving interoperability for technical documentation, developer

workflows, and content management systems.

Performance has improved across the suite. EPUB export is faster and now includes a progress bar. Calc delivers smoother scrolling in sheets with many hidden columns and accelerates

large tables, duplicate removal, and tracked-change rejection. Optimisations also cover SVG exports, 3D chart rendering, and Linux pattern fills.

Compatibility with Microsoft Office formats has been strengthened. Writer enhances DOCX export through Floating Table splitting and better Change Tracking preservation. Calc supports Excel's Biff12 clipboard format and defaults to Excel 2010+ XLSX, easing data exchange with proprietary environments.

Security receives a boost through ODF Wholesome Encryption, combining AES-GCM authenticated encryption with Argon2id key derivation to improve brute-force resistance and reduce metadata leakage.

LibreOffice 26.2 will be supported until November 30, 2026, with certified L3 providers offering extended commercial support for enterprises, schools, and governments.

"LibreOffice 26.2 shows what happens when software is built around users, not business models, and how open source software can deliver a modern, mature productivity suite without compromising user freedom," said Florian Effenberger, executive director of The Document Foundation.



For more news, visit www.opensourceforu.com

Microsoft's chemistry-focused QDK is open source

Microsoft has released an open source Quantum Development Kit (QDK) focused on quantum chemistry and error correction, expanding its Azure Quantum developer ecosystem. Announced on January 22, the tools are available now, with full availability expected through a phased rollout concluding in 2026.

A key differentiator of the release is cross-framework compatibility. Developers can work seamlessly across Q#, OpenQASM, IBM Qiskit, and Google Cirq within a single environment, eliminating the need to switch tools or rewrite programs. By embracing Qiskit rather than competing against it, Microsoft positions itself as a framework-agnostic platform, directly challenging ecosystem lock-in.

The QDK integrates deeply with existing developer workflows through native VS Code support, including Python and Jupyter integration, circuit rendering, IntelliSense, breakpoint debugging, local simulators, and resource estimation. GitHub Copilot further accelerates code generation, testing, and job submission.

"With GitHub Copilot and the QDK, programming tasks such as code generation, unit tests, and job submissions are faster and easier than ever before," said Matthias Troyer, technical fellow and corporate vice president of Quantum at Microsoft.

Industry validation came from Algorithmiq, a Finnish quantum computing startup specialising in computational life sciences. "We believe the modular design of the platform will be a true game changer for quantum chemistry," said Guillermo Garcia-Perez, chief scientific officer at Algorithmiq.